

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS)

Comprehensive Corporate Human Resources Policies & Guidelines Handbook

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1. Introduction & Core Corporate Philosophy

This document encapsulates the standardized global HR framework for Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), strictly guided by the Tata Code of Conduct (TCoC).

At TCS, human resources are viewed as the primary differentiator and the core capital powering global technology delivery. The primary mission of the HR division is to provide an empowering context for energizing and developing talent to meet enterprise delivery and personal growth milestones. Every practice is aligned to the values of the Tata Group: Integrity, Excellence, Unity, Responsibility, and Pioneering.

The TCoC Equal Opportunity Clause: TCS provides equal employment opportunities to all associates and applicants without regard to race, caste, religion, color, ancestry, gender, age, marital status, sexual orientation, or physical disability. Growth is entirely merit-driven and contingent upon individual and team contribution metrics.

2. Workforce Planning & Talent Acquisition

2.1 Demand Forecasting and Resource Planning

Human Resource Planning (HRP) at TCS balances continuous talent readiness with shifting business demands. Resource requests are gathered centrally every quarter and reconciled across multiple dimensions:

- **Geography-Wise:** Evaluating regional talent compliance, visa requirements, and onshore staffing targets.
- **Branch & Delivery Center Level:** Aligning localized recruitment quotas with nearshore or offshore delivery loads.
- **Project-Wise Requirements:** Immediate allocations based on technology stacks, skill-criticality, and billing timelines.

2.2 Recruitment Methods and Channels

TCS employs a multi-channel acquisition infrastructure to maintain its global workforce pipeline:

- **Campus Placement Programs:** Broad academic outreach identifying entry-level engineers and technical graduates.

- **Employee Referral Programs (ERP):** Internal matching framework leveraging the network of existing associates to surface validated technical talent.
- **Lateral Hiring & Professional Agencies:** Targeted recruitment for specialized roles, technical leadership, and domain subject matter experts.

2.3 Selection Framework

The evaluation architecture ensures a technical and behavioral match through a rigid sequence:

Stage	Assessment Focus	Outcome Target
1. Initial Screening	Academic eligibility, credit requirements, and background profile alignment.	Baseline eligibility check.
2. Aptitude Evaluation	Quantitative, analytical reasoning, and computational problem-solving.	Cognitive benchmarking.
3. Technical Interview	Core coding capabilities, data structures, system design, and technology domain mastery.	Skill proficiency validation.
4. Management Review	Project adaptability, multi-tasking competency, and problem ownership.	Operational capability fit.
5. Human Resources Round	Behavioral readiness, alignment with the Tata Code of Conduct, and compensation structures.	Offer letter onboarding release.

3. Learning, Development & Onboarding

3.1 Initial Learning Program (ILP)

All fresh technical graduates entering TCS are mandated to complete the Initial Learning Program (ILP) managed by the Learning & Training (L&T) Department. This intensive program spans up to three months and includes training in enterprise-level tech stacks (e.g., Java, .NET, Full Stack Development, SAP, Cloud Architectures, and Generative AI Tooling) along with intensive business communication and professional ethics modules.

3.2 Continuous Workplace Learning & Just-In-Time (JIT) Training

To remain future-ready, associates participate in ongoing educational frameworks. TCS utilizes AI-led digital learning platforms allowing personalized skill paths. For fast-tracked delivery needs, Just-In-Time (JIT) reactive training is initiated to bridge specific project or technology skill gaps immediately upon project allocation.

4. Employment Conditions & Service Rules

4.1 Service Agreement & Permanent Status

Entry-level hires typically engage in a foundational training and service agreement context (often two years) to offset initial intensive learning investments. Upon successful fulfillment, associates transition smoothly into structured permanent service paths with high long-term job security, which remains a primary contributor to TCS's industry-leading low employee attrition rates.

4.2 Work Arrangements & Shift Operations

TCS operates standard professional shifts aligned with global delivery compliance. Associates are required to adhere to scheduled project timings, with full flexibility built in for rotational night shifts, offshore-onshore handoffs, and situational distributed work setups based on client delivery security rules (ODC protocols).

5. Performance Management & Appraisals

5.1 The Balanced Scorecard Framework

Performance tracking is executed transparently via a Balanced Scorecard methodology evaluated on four primary perspectives:

- **Financial Perspective:** Measures the associate's explicit contribution to revenue growth, cost optimization, and asset utilization.
- **Customer Perspective:** Focuses on service excellence, client satisfaction feedback, and delivery value add.
- **Internal Perspective:** Tracks contributions to operational efficiency, code quality, and methodology compliance.
- **Learning & Growth:** Quantifies new technical certifications acquired and skill level improvements.

5.2 Evaluation Frequency

Appraisals are conducted semi-annually and at specific operational check-points:

- **Project-End Appraisals:** Completed immediately upon delivery rollout or transfer out of a project.
- **Annual Reviews:** A comprehensive consolidation determining increments, promotion potential, and long-term career bands.

6. Compensation, Benefits & Welfare

6.1 Performance-Linked Compensation

The compensation structure emphasizes team success alongside individual accountability. A significant portion of variable payouts is structured around team performance indices, encouraging shared project goals

and reducing individualistic friction. Performance is modeled closely on Economic Value Added (EVA) principles to foster ownership.

6.2 Statutory and Welfare Benefits

Comprehensive financial and health security frameworks are embedded across all delivery layers:

- **Health and Medical Coverage:** Extended health insurance plans for employees and immediate dependents, supported by onsite medical aid facilities.
- **Retirement Provisions:** Fully compliant Provident Fund (PF) channels and standard Retiring Gratuity models matching statutory mandates.
- **Maternity & Paternity Leaves:** Comprehensive leave configurations supporting family-related lifecycle events with complete job security.

7. Code of Conduct, Ethics & Workplace Environment

7.1 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

TCS maintains a zero-tolerance policy regarding harassment of any kind. Internal Complaints Committees (ICC) are independently operationalized across every geography to quickly investigate and resolve grievances, ensuring a safe, supportive working environment for all genders.

7.2 Status Differential Reductions & Open Door Policy

TCS enforces a corporate culture built around an "Open Door Policy," reducing hierarchy barriers. Junior associates are structurally empowered to communicate directly with upper management layers regarding discrimination or unfair project allocation practices. Professional behavioral training ensures equal dignity and respectful communication regardless of designation or payroll band.

8. Leaves & Attendance Regulations

Associates are eligible for a balanced pool of leaves to maintain professional and personal equilibrium:

- **Earned Leave / Paid Time Off (PTO):** Accrued month-on-month, requiring structured manager sign-off prior to project impact.
- **Sick & Casual Leave:** Allocated for unexpected medical occurrences or immediate personal interventions.
- **Sabbaticals & Global Studies Leave:** Provided to high-performing long-term associates for overseas higher education or extended career breaks with specific repatriation tracking.

9. Separation & Exit Policy

9.1 Notice Period & Offboarding Procedures

To ensure continuity of critical technology delivery, standard notice periods (typically up to 90 days depending on the role and geography) must be observed upon resignation. The separation phase triggers standard knowledge transfer (KT) protocols, full-and-final settlement calculations, and compulsory exit interviews to analyze systemic workflow feedback.

9.2 Rehire Eligibility

Ex-employees seeking re-employment are subject to rigorous review. Eligibility depends heavily on a positive separation track record, completion of the required notice period during their previous tenure, and passing fresh background and technical screenings.